Belinda Z. Li

Software Engineer at Facebook AI

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Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology *(incoming, fall 2020)* 2020 –
PhD, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
- (Prospective) Advisor: Jacob Andreas

University of Washington 2015 – 2019
Bachelors of Science, Computer Science, Magna Cum Laude
- Cumulative GPA: 3.94 / 4.0, Major GPA: 3.95 / 4.0
- Advisor: Luke Zettlemoyer
- Highlighted Coursework: Natural Language Processing, NLP Capstone, Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms, Foundations of Computing I/II (Discrete Math & Probability), Honors Accelerated Calculus I/II/III

Robinson Center for Young Scholars 2014 – 2015
GED Equivalent

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[1] Nayeon Lee, Belinda Z. Li, Sinong Wang, Scott Yih, Hao Ma, and Madian Khabsa. 2020. Language models as fact checkers? In *Proceedings of the Third Workshop on Fact Extraction and VERification (FEVER)*, page (to appear). Association for Computational Linguistics

[2] Belinda Z. Li, Gabriel Stanovsky, and Luke Zettlemoyer. 2020. Active learning for coreference resolution using discrete annotation. In *Proceedings of the 58th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, page (to appear). Association for Computational Linguistics

Industry/Research Experience

Facebook AI Aug. 2019 –
Software Engineer, AI Integrity Team (Facebook AI Applied Research)
- (Product) Built multimodal representations for Facebook posts pretrained with self-supervision. Shipped to hate speech domain, improving offline hate speech prevalence metrics by 25%
  - https://ai.facebook.com/blog/ai-advances-to-better-detect-hate-speech/
- (Research) Built an efficient, end-to-end model for entity linking on questions
- (Research) Exploring techniques to improve transformer efficiency on long sequence
- (Research) Helped in devising models for fake news detection: using multi-tasking, or leveraging implicit knowledge in pretrained language models [1]

University of Washington 2018 – 2019
Undergraduate Research Assistant, with Luke Zettlemoyer
- Devised new annotation technique for active learning for coreference resolution, see [2]
- Explored models for entity-to-entity sentiment analysis

Facebook June 2018 – Aug. 2018
Software Engineer Intern, Bot Detection Team
- Worked on mouse movement tracking and classification for bot detection, using heuristic techniques, as well as supervised and unsupervised ML models (gradient boosting tree classifiers, K-means clustering)
- Obtained highest return offer

University of Washington June 2016 – Aug. 2016
Undergraduate Research Assistant, UW Biological Structures

- MATLAB program for triangulating locations of vesicles from 2D images

Teaching

University of Washington
Teaching Assistant

- Responsibilities (mostly) entailed grading, leading weekly section, hosting office hours and review sessions, and weekly meetings with course staff. List of courses below:
- CSE 311: Foundations of Computing I (Discrete Math) — Spring 2019
  - Instructor: Kevin Zatloukal
- CSE 312: Foundations of Computing II (Probability/Statistics) — Winter 2019
  - Instructor: Martin Tompa
- CSE 312: Foundations of Computing II (Probability/Statistics) — Winter 2018
  - Instructor: Martin Tompa
- CSE 331: Software Design and Implementation — Autumn 2017
  - Instructor: Kevin Zatloukal

Awards

Ida M. Green Memorial Fellowship — 2020 – 2021
Denice Dee Denton Scholars Endowment — 2018 – 2019
Dean's List — 2015 – 2017 (annual), SP18/F18/SP19 (quarterly)
National Merit Scholar — 2016

Service

Program Committee: COLING 2020

Miscellany

Overseas Taoli Cup Dance Competition Gold Medal (2016); ABRSM Grade 8 Piano Pass with Distinction (2016); Mentor, Robinson Center for Young Scholars (2015-2016); Volunteer, UW Farms (Spring 2015)